Pete led me into a studio and stopped me in front of a microphone.

"When the red light goes on," he said, "I'll be in another room listening. Describe an imaginary football game to me and make me *see* it."

My mind raced for something that would impress him. I decided I had to describe a game with high drama and an exciting finish, name names and describe specific plays. The names were the big thing. How could I come up with different names as I described a play?

I decided the answer was to describe one of the games at Eureka in which I'd played; I'd know the plays and the players.

The previous season we'd won a game in the last twenty seconds with a sixty-five-yard touchdown run by quarterback Bud Cole, my fraternity brother who had done me in on the stage at Northwestern. It was as exciting a game as I'd ever played.

As I stood at the microphone, my only rehearsal for that moment had been those imaginary broomstick interviews in the TKE house. Suddenly the red light flashed on. I looked at the microphone and improvised:

"Here we are in the fourth quarter with Western State University leading Eureka College six to nothing. . . .

"Long blue shadows are settling over the field and a chill wind is blowing in through the end of the stadium. . . ."

(We didn't have a stadium, we had bleachers, but I didn't expect him to know the difference.)

I let the teams seesaw across the field for almost fifteen minutes, then began leading up to that final play, an off-tackle smash. When we played that game, I never knew how Bud made it to the goal line. On the play, the right guard—that was I—was supposed to pull out of the line immediately after the ball was snapped, lead our interference through